

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 7 2
 ♥ K 9 6 4
 ♦ 9 2
 ♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5
 ♥ 10 8 3
 ♦ K Q J 10 7
 ♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North

surely still have a ♥ loser. But if you finesse the ♣K successfully you will eliminate your ♣ loser.

North is to play 4♠. East leads the ♦K.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 4

East has made another great lead. Any other suit would have given you a free finesse. You should duck the first ♦. It is very possible that East has led from ♦K Q 10 and will be afraid to continue for fear you have the ♦J in your hand. You'd be very happy to see him switch to any other suit. But he doesn't, he continues with the ♦Q which you take with dummy's ♦A.

You are in dummy for the first, last, and only time. You need to try a finesse right now, but which one? At first you might think it makes no difference but, in fact, there is only one reasonable choice. If you finesse the ♠K successfully you may still have a ♠ loser. If you finesse the ♥K successfully you will

What a great layout! Three possible finesses and every one of them would work.

But as you can see, only the ♣ finesse will actually save you a trick.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 7 3

♥ 9 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A Q J 10

♠ -

♥ 10 8 7 3

♦ K J 9 4

♣ K 8 6 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7

♠ 10 2

♥ K Q J 5 2

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

Pass

4NT

Pass

5 ♥

Pass

6 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by East

♥ loser. South may be able to win the trick but you can ruff a ♥ return, and dummy will have two good ♣s on which you can discard 2 ♦ losers.

East is to play 6 ♠. South leads the ♥ K.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=0 Total = 3

Your only hope for ridding yourself of two of those losers is dummy's ♣ suit. One possibility would be to finesse South for the ♣ K, and if that works, discard your ♥ loser on the ♣ A. You could then establish another ♣ winner for one of the ♦ losers. The problem with that plan is that if the finesse fails the defense will immediately take the setting ♥ trick.

A better plan is a ruffing finesse. Win the first trick with your ♥ A and pull trumps with your ♠ K Q.

Next play your ♣ 7 to dummy's ♣ A. Then lead the ♣ Q from dummy. If North plays the ♣ K you will ruff, enter dummy, and discard two red losers on the ♣ J 10. If North plays low instead, you discard your

Ruffing finesses sometimes provide you the best opportunity, like this time.

But they are easy to overlook, mainly because we don't use them often.

Board 5

West Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5

N
W E
S

♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K Q J 10 7

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

Board 5

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 8 7 3
♥ 9 6
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A Q J 10

♠ -
♥ 10 8 7 3
♦ K J 9 4
♣ K 8 6 5 2

N
W E
 S

♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4
♥ A 4
♦ A 5 2
♣ 7

♠ 10 2
♥ K Q J 5 2
♦ Q 10 8
♣ 9 4 3

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5



♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K Q J 10 7

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 7 3
♥ 9 6
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A Q J 10

♠ -

♥ 10 8 7 3

♦ K J 9 4

♣ K 8 6 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7

♠ 10 2

♥ K Q J 5 2

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

Board 9

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5



♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K Q J 10 7

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 7 3

♥ 9 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A Q J 10

♠ -

♥ 10 8 7 3

♦ K J 9 4

♣ K 8 6 5 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7

♠ 10 2

♥ K Q J 5 2

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5



♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

Board 13

North Deals
Both Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8
♥ A Q J
♦ 8 4
♣ A Q



♠ 6 5
♥ 10 8 3
♦ K Q J 10 7
♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 6 5 3
♣ J 10 9 5

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 7 3

♥ 9 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A Q J 10

♠ -

♥ 10 8 7 3

♦ K J 9 4

♣ K 8 6 5 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7

♠ 10 2

♥ K Q J 5 2

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5



♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K Q J 10 7

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

Board 17

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 8 7 3
♥ 9 6
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A Q J 10

♠ -
♥ 10 8 7 3
♦ K J 9 4
♣ K 8 6 5 2

N
W E
 S

♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4
♥ A 4
♦ A 5 2
♣ 7

♠ 10 2
♥ K Q J 5 2
♦ Q 10 8
♣ 9 4 3

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5



♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K Q J 10 7

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7 3
♥ 9 6
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A Q J 10

♠ -

♥ 10 8 7 3

♦ K J 9 4

♣ K 8 6 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7

♠ 10 2

♥ K Q J 5 2

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

Board 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5



♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K Q J 10 7

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7 3

♥ 9 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A Q J 10

♠ -

♥ 10 8 7 3

♦ K J 9 4

♣ K 8 6 5 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7

♠ 10 2

♥ K Q J 5 2

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

Board 25

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K Q J 10 7

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7 3

♥ 9 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A Q J 10

♠ -

♥ 10 8 7 3

♦ K J 9 4

♣ K 8 6 5 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7

♠ 10 2

♥ K Q J 5 2

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

Board 27

South Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5

N
W E
 S

♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K Q J 10 7

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

Board 29

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7 3

♥ 9 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A Q J 10

♠ -

♥ 10 8 7 3

♦ K J 9 4

♣ K 8 6 5 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7

♠ 10 2

♥ K Q J 5 2

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5

N
W E
S

♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

Board 31

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K Q J 10 7

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 7 3
♥ 9 6
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A Q J 10

♠ -

♥ 10 8 7 3

♦ K J 9 4

♣ K 8 6 5 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7

♠ 10 2

♥ K Q J 5 2

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

Board 33

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K 9 6 4
♦ 9 2
♣ K 7 6 3

♠ A Q J 10 9 8

♥ A Q J

♦ 8 4

♣ A Q



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K Q J 10 7

♣ 8 4 2

♠ 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 6 5 3

♣ J 10 9 5

Board 35

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 8 7 3
♥ 9 6
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A Q J 10

♠ -
♥ 10 8 7 3
♦ K J 9 4
♣ K 8 6 5 2

N
W E
 S

♠ K Q J 9 6 5 4
♥ A 4
♦ A 5 2
♣ 7

♠ 10 2
♥ K Q J 5 2
♦ Q 10 8
♣ 9 4 3

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 10 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5



♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2